Elshan Garashli

PhD Candidate in Economics

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Education

University of Graz, Austria — *2020–2026 (exp.)*
PhD in Economics
Dissertation: "Robust Strategic Communication"
Supervisor: **Christoph Kuzmics**

University of Colorado Boulder, USA — *10/2024–11/2024*
Visiting PhD Student, Department of Economics
Host: **Ernesto Rivera Mora**

University of Arizona, USA — *09/2023–12/2023*
Visiting PhD Student, Department of Economics
Hosts: **Andreas Blume** and **Inga Deimen**

University of Vienna, Austria
MSc in Economics — *2015–2019*
BSc in Economics — *2012–2015*

Research Fields

Microeconomic Theory, Information Economics, Communication Games

Publications

Robust Equilibria in Cheap-Talk Games with Fairly Transparent Motives
Forthcoming in *Games and Economic Behavior*
With Jan-Henrik Steg, Michael Greinecker, and Christoph Kuzmics

Abstract: Equilibria of cheap-talk games in which the sender has state-independent preferences are generally not robust to introducing slight dependence on the state. Some equilibria, however, can be approximated by robust equilibria of nearby cheap-talk games with slightly state-dependent sender preferences. We characterize these equilibria for all games with binary state space and show that, in particular, the maximal equilibrium payoff for the sender can always be robustly approximated in this sense.

Working Papers

Multi-sender cheap talk with almost common information
Job Market Paper

Abstract: Multiple experts often observe information that is nearly, but not exactly, common. We study a multi-sender cheap talk model with an ε-mixture prior that varies correlation while holding marginals fixed. Correlation determines which message profiles are governed by Bayes' rule. Full revelation can be supported at perfect correlation, but any independent component rules it out. This is not a collapse of communication. Informative equilibria still exist with almost common information and can be partitional or nonpartitional. With similar information, partitional equilibria survive only on a strict subset of their perfect-correlation bias region, while nonpartitional equilibria remain feasible throughout their perfect-correlation bias region.

Strategic Communication with Partial Expertise

Abstract: Decision makers rely on experts who observe part of the information relevant to a choice. We study communication when an expert observes one component of a decision target but her observation also predicts a missing component. This indirect information can sustain communication despite conflicts of interest. The largest conflict consistent with informative communication depends on what extreme observations imply about the missing component, not on correlation alone. When this prediction is linear, higher correlation permits finer communication and raises the value of listening relative to no information. Yet this need not improve welfare because the decision itself becomes more difficult.

Presentations at Conferences, Seminars and Summer Schools

SAET, Rio de Janeiro	July 2026
PET, Rio de Janeiro	July 2026
CEPET, University of Udine	June 2026
Annual Conference of the Austrian Economic Association (NOeG), Krems	September 2025
18th RGS Doctoral Conference in Economics, TU Dortmund University	February 2025
BIGSEM-Workshop, University of Bielefeld	December 2024
IO/Micro Brownbag, University of Colorado Boulder	November 2024
Seminar Talk, ADA University, Baku	September 2024
Summer School Recent Advances in Mechanism and Information Design, University of Bonn	August 2024
Seminar Talk, Università Ca' Foscari, Venice	June 2024
CEPET, University of Udine	June 2024
Vienna Economics PhD Workshop, Central European University, Vienna	April 2024
SAET, University of Chile, Santiago	January 2024
IBE Theory Lunch, University of Arizona	October 2023

Fellowships, Grants, and Awards

Grant, Research Careers Campus Graz, €1,000	2026
Full Grant for the 8th Lindau Nobel Meeting in Economic Sciences, Austrian Federal Ministry of Education, Science and Research	2025
Dissertation Fellowship, Nationalökonomische Gesellschaft (NOeG), €4,000	2024
Thesis/Dissertation Scholarship, SBESS, €3,600	2024
Research Grant, OeNB Jubiläumsfonds, Oesterreichische Nationalbank	2023
Thesis/Dissertation Scholarship, SBESS, €3,600	2023

Teaching Experience

University of Graz

Introduction to Management Accounting, undergraduate (*German*)	*Summer term 2027 (scheduled)*
Quantitative Research Methods 2, graduate (*German/English*)	*Summer term 2027 (scheduled)*
Organization and Institutional Economics Seminar, graduate (*German/English*)	*Winter term 2026/27*
Seminar in Organizational Design and Incentives in Firms, graduate (*English*)	*Winter term 2026/27*
Quantitative Research Methods 2, graduate (*German/English*)	*Winter term 2026/27*
Quantitative Research Methods 2, graduate (*German/English*)	*Summer term 2026*
Microeconomics, undergraduate (*German*)	*Summer term 2024*
Game Theory, graduate (*English*)	*Winter term 2023/24*
Macroeconomics, undergraduate (*German*)	*Summer term 2023*
Macroeconomics, undergraduate (*German*)	*Winter term 2022/23*
Macroeconomics, undergraduate (*German*)	*Summer term 2022*
Macroeconomics, undergraduate (*German*)	*Winter term 2021/22*
Macroeconomics, undergraduate (*German*)	*Summer term 2021*
Macroeconomics, undergraduate (*German*)	*Winter term 2020/21*

Vienna University of Technology: Master's-level seminar and co-supervision of master's and undergraduate theses — *2019–2020*

University of Vienna: Teaching assistance and exam reviews in applied microeconomics and game theory — *2017–2018*

Academic Positions

University Assistant, Department for Organization and Institutional Economics, University of Graz — *11/2025–present*

University Assistant, Institute of Economics, University of Graz — *10/2020–09/2025*

Researcher, Energy Economics Group, Vienna University of Technology — *10/2019–09/2020*

Teaching and Research Assistant, University of Vienna — *09/2017–09/2018*
Chair of Industry, Energy and Environment, Faculty of Business, Economics and Statistics

Additional Information

Primary working languages: English and German (fluent)
Additional languages: Turkish (fluent), Azerbaijani (native), Russian (intermediate)
Software: Python, Matlab, R, Mathematica
Citizenship: Austria

References

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